Hamed Gholami, Ph.D.

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WORK EXPERIENCE

SusMAL LLC Feb. 2025 – Present

R&D Director & Senior CI Consultant

- Lead client advisory engagements for 4-6 manufacturing organizations annually, delivering strategic roadmaps and ROI-driven business cases with improvement potential of $150K-$1M per workstream.
- Design and deploy standardized CI deliverables, including SOPs, KPI frameworks, control plans, process maps, and training modules, enabling network-wide rollouts across multi-site client operations.
- Drive change management and the adoption of Lean culture across client sites by building LSS maturity models (EFA/CFA) that link site readiness scores to KPI targets and savings forecasts.
- Translate AI and Industry 4.0 technologies into Lean process redesign solutions, integrating predictive analytics and decision-support tools for measurable operational impact.
- Influence senior stakeholders across Finance, Operations, and IT without direct authority, aligning investment in improvements with strategic priorities through benchmarking and data-driven business cases.

Mines Saint-Etienne – LIMOS Laboratory Oct. 2022 – Sept. 2024

Assistant Professor & Applied R&D Researcher

- Led Lean Six Sigma, process engineering, and Industry 4.0 R&D programs across multi-site industry partnerships, delivering scalable improvement solutions with documented ROI and compliance controls.
- Developed an AI-enabled KPI assessment tool (LLMs + fuzzy logic, Python) that standardized performance reviews and accelerated operational decision-making across manufacturing environments.
- Built MATLAB optimization algorithms for sustainable supply chain systems, improving computational efficiency by 88% and reducing modeled planning and logistics costs by 21%.
- Constructed Power BI dashboards to monitor KPIs, surface variance-to-target, and prioritize CI actions across network-wide multi-site operations in real time.
- Facilitated graduate-level workshops in Lean Manufacturing and Data Analytics, coaching 20-30 students annually, and building CI capability through real-world application.

Springer Nature Dec. 2022 - Nov. 2023

Lead Editor (Editorial Project Lead) - Sustainable Manufacturing & Industry 4.0

- Directed cross-border collaboration among 3 senior co-editors across 3 continents, 5 Springer Nature Singapore editors, 10+ peer reviewers, and 30+ global contributors to publish a peer-reviewed volume on sustainable manufacturing and Industry 4.0
- Synthesized cutting-edge research across Lean systems, digital transformation, and sustainable operations from 30+ international contributors into a cohesive, publication-ready volume, translating complex technical content into a structured, globally accessible deliverable.
- Managed end-to-end editorial lifecycle, from proposal submission through final publication, aligning diverse stakeholders across academic, publishing, and industry audiences while maintaining academic rigor, thematic coherence, and Springer Nature's global editorial standards.

Universiti Teknologi Malaysia – UTM Industry Research Laboratory Jan. 2018 – Jun. 2022

Continuous Improvement Specialist (Postdoctoral Fellow)

- Planned and facilitated 5-day end-to-end Kaizen events with cross-functional teams of 10-12, influencing plant supervisors and engineers without authority from current-state VSM through control plan deployment.
- Reduced chemical consumption by 28%, energy usage by 21%, and improved safety outcomes (REBA risk score reduced from 9 to 5), achieving ISO 14001/45001/50001 alignment (published, 2021).
- Cut total cycle time by 17% and indirect material costs by 5% ($5,029 to $4,774/cycle) by redesigning standard work and tightening SPC parameters (published, 2020).
- Built Power BI dashboards and led structured 30/60/90-day post-event reviews, sustaining 25-28% chemical and 18-21% energy reductions with minimal variance drift.
- Trained 10-15 operators, technicians, and engineers on A3/8D, MSA, and standard work, developing internal CI champions and embedding a continuous improvement culture across shifts.

Seagate Oct. 2013 – Oct. 2017

Process Engineer

- Owned the electroless nickel plating process end-to-end, enforcing the control plan through layered audits and SPC monitoring to maintain yield, stability, and uptime in high-volume production.
- Led Lean Six Sigma projects using root cause analysis, 5 Whys, fishbone, and DOE to improve first-pass yield, reduce defect escape, and lower cost per unit.
- Conducted PFMEA, linked risk findings to preventive maintenance and control plans, and drove capacity planning adjustments that reduced unplanned downtime and strengthened process reliability.
- Certified LSS Green Belt; facilitated operator workshops on standard work and poka-yoke, supporting ISO 9001 compliance and audit readiness across all production shifts.

EDUCATION

Universiti Teknologi Malaysia
Ph.D., Mechanical Engineering
Best Ph.D. Scientist Award

Universiti Teknologi Malaysia
M.Eng., Industrial Engineering

Bu-Ali Sina University
B.Sc., Industrial Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- **Lean Six Sigma Post-Doctoral Certification (Black Belt Scope)** – Universiti Teknologi Malaysia (UTM) in collaboration with Seagate, March 2020
- **Certified Professional Technologist (PTech)** – Board of Technologists (MBOT), June 2021
- **Graduate Technologist** – Board of Technologists (MBOT), September 2020
- **Supply Chain Research with anyLogistix: Digital Twin & Supply Chain Modeling** – anyLogistix / AnyLogic Company, November 2023
- **Industrial Engineering and Operations Management (IEOM) Society** – Professional Member; Data Analytics Award Recipient, July 2023
- **American Society for Quality (ASQ)** – Quality Management Journal Reviewer; Former Professional Member

CORE COMPETENCIES

Lean, Continuous Improvement & Operational Excellence: Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC/DMADV) | Kaizen Facilitation | Value Stream Mapping | Process Redesign | 5S | SMED | A3/8D | FMEA/PFMEA | Standard Work | Waste Elimination | Root Cause Analysis | Hoshin Kanri

Manufacturing, Operations & Supply Chain: Manufacturing Systems | Process Standardization | SPC | Cp/Cpk | DOE | TQM | Throughput Optimization | Cycle Time Reduction | Capacity Planning | Automation | Line Balancing | Production Planning | Supply Chain Optimization | Inventory Optimization | ISO 9001/14001/45001/50001

Analytics, Digital Transformation & Industry: Power BI | Python | SQL | MATLAB | Minitab | Excel (Advanced) | Tableau | SolidWorks / CAD Familiarity | Predictive Analytics | Benchmarking | AI-Enabled Manufacturing Systems | Data-Driven Decision Making | Smart Manufacturing | Industry 4.0 technologies | Digital Transformation | Decision Support Systems

Leadership & Consulting Strategy: Stakeholder Management | Cross-Functional Leadership | Influence Without Authority | Operational Transformation | Client Advisory | Change Management | Strategic Planning | Performance Improvement | Workshop Facilitation | ROI Business Cases | Executive Reporting | Multi-Site Deployment